

Chapter 168-1

Lin Luoxi and Sally's wedding was held in Haizhou.

The bridesmaids were Yang Shuyan and Su Meiqi.

Coincidentally, it snowed heavily on the wedding day, blanketing the ground with a thick layer of white frost.

Fortunately, since it was winter, there was no outdoor setup—everything was indoors.

The wedding was kept simple.

Lin Luoxi didn't like fuss, so it was held at a hotel. There weren't too many guests, nor too many elaborate proceedings.

After the ceremony ended, Lin Luoxi threw the bouquet. With her back to everyone, she raised her hand, and the bouquet landed in the crowd, hitting Su Meiqi squarely.

Su Meiqi: "?"

She treated it like a hot potato and immediately tossed it to Yang Shuyan.

Yang Shuyan: "?"

In the end, Yang Shuyan was the one who caught the bouquet.

In Su Meiqi's words: "I don't even have a partner. What's the point of having a bouquet? Besides, I'm still young. I'm not getting married."

Zhou Yi'an, who was standing right beside her, looked her up and down and scoffed lightly. "Weren't you just saying a few days ago that you wanted to marry Song Qi?"

Su Meiqi pouted. "That was just talk. Song Qi and I are worlds apart."

Zhou Yi'an frowned. "You're not as good as Song Qi? Some eighteenth-tier minor celebrity..."

"I won't let you talk about Song Qi like that! She's my idol!" Su Meiqi said. "She's as wonderful as clouds in the sky."

"It's snowing today." Zhou Yi'an was speechless at her star-chasing behavior and knocked her on the forehead with her hand. "No clouds."

Su Meiqi: "...?"

"Let me tell you." Su Meiqi took out her phone. "Sis An, you have to see my idol's stage performances. She has abs! I literally drool over them. Plus, she cosplayed my favorite anime character. That styling... *hah~*"

Just as she finished speaking, Zhou Yi'an suddenly turned around. Su Meiqi, who had been following closely behind her, was caught off guard by her sudden stop. Her phone hit Zhou Yi'an's body, and she nearly crashed into her too.

It was Zhou Yi'an who steadied her.

Su Meiqi was wearing a white bridesmaid dress with seven-centimeter heels.

She could barely meet Zhou Yi'an's eyes at the same level.

"What are you—mmph..." She was about to scold Zhou Yi'an, but her cheeks were pinched, and she couldn't speak.

Zhou Yi'an pinched her face with two fingers and said, "I'm not interested in her."

Su Meiqi: "..."

Su Meiqi's eyes were round, and with her cheeks in Zhou Yi'an's hands, she looked like a cute little hamster.

People were coming and going around them. Su Meiqi felt embarrassed and glared at her threateningly. "Mmph mmph mmph mmph!"

"What did you say?" Zhou Yi'an asked.

Su Meiqi: "?"

She lifted her foot and kicked Zhou Yi'an. A muddy footprint immediately appeared on those black dress pants.

As everyone knew, Zhou Yi'an was famously a neat freak.

Some company colleagues who had come to attend the wedding saw this and immediately started whispering. "It's over. The loner weirdo is going to get angry."

"Probably not, right? She's always been nice to Meiqi."

"But that's the loner weirdo! The clean freak! Last time, a new colleague tried to flirt with her and deliberately created a chance encounter. She spilled coffee on her shirt. You know what she said?"

"What?"

"She told that person to grow a brain."

"..."

Even when she wasn't angry, Zhou Yi'an was the kind of person no one dared to approach.

But the anger everyone anticipated from Zhou Yi'an didn't come. She just lowered her head to glance at her soiled pants, furrowed her brow slightly, and scolded in a low voice, "Getting brave, aren't you?"

Su Meiqi continued to struggle. "Mmph mmph mmph mmph mmph mmph mmph!"

Zhou Yi'an let go. "There, I let go. Speak."

Su Meiqi's teeth ached from being pinched. She rubbed her face before saying, "You're too much!"

"How so?" Zhou Yi'an raised an eyebrow.

Su Meiqi righteously condemned her. "Who told you to pinch my face? It hurts!"

"I controlled my strength," Zhou Yi'an said. "Don't exaggerate."

"It really hurts." Su Meiqi rubbed the spot where she had just been pinched. "It's definitely going to peel."

Zhou Yi'an: "...?"

"Drama queen." Zhou Yi'an raised her hand to move Su Meiqi's hand away and took a look. The young girl's skin was tender, her face full of collagen. Her eyes were sparkling bright, and her mascara-coated lashes were long and curled, fluttering like a Barbie doll.

Su Meiqi had the typical look of a 2D anime girl—a round face with a touch of baby fat, lychee-shaped eyes,¹ and a soft voice. So even though she often looked like she was flailing about trying to intimidate people, in everyone else's eyes, she had zero offensive power.

Zhou Yi'an couldn't help herself and pinched her face again.

Su Meiqi: "?"

She kicked Zhou Yi'an again.

"What are you doing? Are your hands itchy?" Su Meiqi glared at her with round eyes and scolded her. "I'm practically dying from the pain."

Zhou Yi'an awkwardly withdrew her hand and put one hand in her pocket.

"Force of habit." Zhou Yi'an didn't dare look at Su Meiqi again and made up an excuse on the spot. "You've gained weight recently. The texture feels especially nice."

Su Meiqi: "...?"

That was practically dancing on a landmine in front of a pretty girl.

"Zhou Yi'an!" Su Meiqi angrily called her by her full name. "Are you asking for death?"

"You'll kill me?" Zhou Yi'an's voice was flat as she glanced over casually. Those eyes seemed to carry a hint of anticipation.

Zhou Yi'an had small pupils, and when she looked at people frivolously, it made her appear rather wicked.

Su Meiqi was stunned. "Why would I kill you?"

Zhou Yi'an chuckled lightly. "Don't you want me dead?"

"Killing people is illegal." Su Meiqi was annoyed.

But this was the first time Su Meiqi had seen Zhou Yi'an like this.

Usually, Zhou Yi'an appeared more like a mischievous older sister in front of her—somewhat deep, as if hiding many secrets, often teasing her for fun.

When she spoke so seriously like this, Su Meiqi instantly sensed her desire for death.

1. Lychee eyes (荔枝眼): A type of eye shape in Chinese beauty standards, characterized by round, bright eyes that resemble the shape of a lychee fruit—large, round, and sparkling.

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"I can choose not to hold you accountable." Zhou Yi'an was still smiling.

Su Meiqi's back went cold. "You... you..."

She stammered twice before getting the words out: "Don't scare me, Sis An'an."

Seeing tears welling up in her eyes, Zhou Yi'an's heart suddenly softened. She raised her hand and patted her head. "Alright, I was just joking with you."

"You... that joke wasn't very funny." Su Meiqi moved closer, looking at her pleadingly. "Although I usually say I'll beat you to death, I want you to stay alive, really. You..."

Su Meiqi paused, then suddenly asked, "Did you get your heart broken? That's okay too. There are thousands of BOs in the world—if one treats you badly, just switch every day. You're so outstanding. Are you worried you can't find a good BO?"

"But..." Su Meiqi bit her lip. "You really aren't thinking of ending your life, are you?"

Zhou Yi'an looked at her expression—aggrieved and pitiful—and turned to walk away. "I already said I was teasing you."

Su Meiqi chased after her. "Zhou Yi'an, I'm telling you, you really can't kill yourself."

Zhou Yi'an: "...Are you hoping I'll die?"

Su Meiqi: "Yes, yes, yes! I'm hoping! Then I can attend the funeral feast!"¹

Zhou Yi'an suddenly stopped. Su Meiqi was running too fast and couldn't brake in time. She crashed right into Zhou Yi'an's arms.

For a moment, their surroundings fell silent.

Su Meiqi swallowed, then immediately stepped back as if she had springs attached to her body.

"What are you doing?" Su Meiqi complained, rubbing her chin that had been bumped. "Good thing mine is original equipment, otherwise it would have fallen off."

Zhou Yi'an, who had been keeping a cold face, was amused by her. She raised her hand and flicked her forehead. "Go play."

Then she turned and left.

"What about you?" Su Meiqi asked.

Zhou Yi'an raised her hand and waved. "I'm leaving first."

Su Meiqi watched her retreating figure, standing there in a daze.

A few seconds later, she took out her phone and frantically tapped the screen.

【Sis An'an, don't die, you hear me?】

【Let me tell you, if you die, you'll never see this gorgeous beauty again.】

【Sheng Yu will cry so hard I definitely won't be able to hold her back.】

【Your family has so much money. Don't you need to inherit it? You've earned so much, and the money isn't even spent yet. You're not allowed to die.】

【No, I have a bad feeling about this.】

After a while, Zhou Yi'an finally replied: 【It was fake.】

Zhou Yi'an: 【Not dying.】

Zhou Yi'an: 【You talk too much.】

Su Meiqi: 【I'm just scared you might do something stupid, wuwuwu. What if I really can't see you anymore in the future?】

Zhou Yi'an: 【I'll leave my unspent money to you. You can still attend the funeral feast.】

Su Meiqi: 【Who wants to attend a funeral feast? Stop being crazy.】

Zhou Yi'an: 【Got it.】

After replying to Su Meiqi, Zhou Yi'an finally took out a cigarette and lighter from her pocket and lazily lit one.

The gray-blue smoke dispersed in the air, the ember flickering on and off.

Zhou Yi'an was just... a little bit sad.

Coming to the wedding was just to give a monetary gift, but she had seen Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu sitting to the side, speaking quietly.

Liang Shi was gentle and calm, without a trace of hostility.

She was a very good person.

And it was true that she couldn't bring herself to like her.

The one she was interested in was still the former Liang Shi. Just meeting eyes had given her a faint sense of excitement.

A desire to conquer.

It was like someone walking in the darkness meeting another person walking in the darkness—with just one look, you knew what kind of person the other was.

But the current Liang Shi didn't have that.

Being at a wedding venue really did make one more contemplative than usual. Her father had also been trying to find her a marriage partner.

She had gone to meet them twice, but couldn't muster any interest.

Thinking of Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu she had just seen, she felt somewhat uncomfortable.

While she was lost in thought, the cigarette in her hand burned out.

Her phone buzzed again. It was still from Su Meiqi.

【Where are you? I'm coming to find you.】

【I'm worried.】

Zhou Yi'an: 【What's there to worry about? It's not like I'm really going to die.】

Su Meiqi sent a voice message: "Zhou Yi'an, you scared me just now."

There was a tearful tone in her voice.

"I want to see you." Su Meiqi's voice in the message was choked. "How can you even have thoughts like that?"

Zhou Yi'an: 【...】

Zhou Yi'an: 【At the entrance.】

Su Meiqi ran out. When she saw her, she sprinted over directly, stopping in front of her. Only after looking her over several times did she sniffle. "You scared me to death."

Zhou Yi'an: "..."

Su Meiqi's hair was all messed up from running. Zhou Yi'an raised her hand to fix her hair and said calmly, "What's there to cry about?"

Su Meiqi continued sniffing. "I... I liked a blogger a while ago. She... she... she committed suicide the day before yesterday. Before she died, she was livestreaming and said the same things. I... I was scared you'd die."

Zhou Yi'an: "..."

"I was really just casually joking." Zhou Yi'an patted her head. "Such a scaredy-cat."

Su Meiqi glared at her. "You're so annoying."

While the two were talking there, not far away, Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu also came out from the wedding venue.

Liang Shi saw Xu Qingzhu stop to look, so she looked too. She suddenly asked in a low voice, "Are those two together?"

"I don't think so." Xu Qingzhu said, "If they were together, Meiqi would definitely make sure the whole world knew. Besides... Zhou Yi'an likes someone else."

As she said this, she glanced at Liang Shi.

Liang Shi: "..."

"It's not me." Liang Shi immediately distanced herself. "The person she likes is someone else."

Xu Qingzhu frowned. "Maybe it's a case of like attracting like? Anyway, they're both pretty crazy."

Liang Shi agreed with her words, but seeing how close Su Meiqi and Zhou Yi'an seemed, she couldn't help but ask, "So what would you do if Zhou Yi'an and Meiqi really got together?"

Xu Qingzhu: "...Break them up, I suppose."

Liang Shi: "?"

Xu Qingzhu said expressionlessly, "She's not worthy of my innocent and adorable little sister."

Liang Shi: "..."

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1. Funeral feast (吃席): In Chinese culture, funerals often include a banquet for guests. Su Meiqi is being sarcastic here, saying if Zhou Yi'an dies, at least she'll get a free meal at the funeral—a dark humor way of expressing she doesn't actually want her to die. ⇐